THEATRE

A STORY OF BORROWED LIVES

Mohit Takalkar explores the fragility of identity in *Dil Ka Haal Sune Dilwala*, a new play for Aadyam Theatre



After opening its eighth season with the spooky thriller *Ankahi*, Aadyam Theatre—an Aditya Birla Group initiative—is ready to stage its second production in Delhi, followed by Mumbai. *Dil Ka Haal Sune Dilwala* is a playful adaptation of American playwright Sarah Ruhl's *Dead Man's Cell Phone*, infused with music and humour, and reimagined within the pulse and texture of Mumbai.

The play revolves around a struggling actress, Asha Parekh, who answers the phone of a deceased man in a café. In

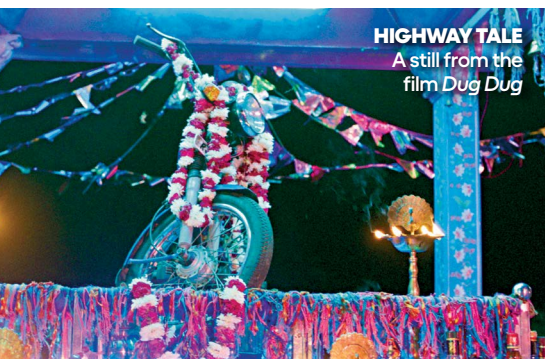


"IT IS A BIZARRE SITUATION—A WOMAN ANSWERING A DEAD MAN'S PHONE AND SLOWLY GETTING PULLED INTO HIS LIFE," TAKALKAR SAYS, DESCRIBING THE PLOT

CINEMA

Keeping the Faith

Ritwik Pareek's satirical film inspired by Rajasthan's Bullet Baba is all set for a theatrical release



HIGHWAY TALE A still from the film *Dug Dug*

When filmmaker Ritwik Pareek first conceived *Dug Dug*, his debut feature, he wasn't thinking about religion. He was thinking about belief itself. "I wanted to make a movie on this idea about thought shaping your reality," he says. "Superstitions are superstitions because we start believing in them. They don't work if you don't believe in them."

That kernel of an idea grew into a sharp, surprisingly warm satire about how faith is made and sold. Inspired by the Bullet Baba temple in Rajasthan, where a Royal Enfield motorcycle is worshipped as a deity after its owner died in a highway accident decades ago, the film follows Thakur, a middle-aged alcoholic whose death on a desert highway sets off a chain of increasingly absurd events. His motorcycle keeps mysteriously returning to the